Messy names, wrong counts

Data engineering · Level 2 · Lesson 2



In this lesson you will

- Spot spaces, capitals and spellings that break counts.
- Clean step by step: tidy, then match a list.
- Clean text in Python with strip() and lower().

Key ideas

- Computers compare text exactly.
- Spaces, letters, then a list.
- A drop-down list stops the mess.

Clean the poll

1. Vote (3 min): write your answer
2. Count (4 min): as written
3. Clean (5 min): spaces, letters, list
4. Recount (3 min): what changed?

Encourage different spellings on purpose, so there’s plenty to clean.

Let’s discuss

1. Why does a computer count “Zoo” and “zoo” separately?
2. Which cleaning step found the most differences?
3. How would a drop-down list help?

Exit ticket

- Write one answer three ways a computer would count as three, and its clean form.